

Expository Writing (SS1014)

Course Instructor(s):

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Section(s): AI, CS, CY, DS and SE Streams

Sessional-I Exam

Total Time (Hrs): 1

Total Marks: 45

Total Questions: 3

Date: Feb 21, 2026



Roll No

Do not write below this line.



Course Section



Student Signature

Attempt all the questions.

[CLO 1: Analyze the main ideas in a text, differentiate between facts and opinions, deduce the meanings of unfamiliar words from context, and draw inferences based on text comprehension.]

Q1: Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow. Each question has four answer choices (A, B, C and D). Choose the best answer based on what is stated or implied in the passage. There is **only ONE** correct answer. Transfer the answers (A, B, C, or D) to the table provided on page 13. **[10 marks]**

Can Machines Truly Understand Language?

Modern artificial intelligence systems can write essays, answer questions, generate computer code, and hold conversations that appear remarkably human. Their fluency has revived an old philosophical question: when a system uses language convincingly, does that mean it actually understands what it is saying? The answer depends not only on technology, but also on how we define understanding itself.

Early attempts at machine language relied on symbolic rules carefully written by programmers. These systems treated language as a logical structure composed of grammar rules and dictionaries of meaning. While they performed well in controlled situations, they struggled with ambiguity and context. Human communication often depends on shared knowledge, cultural assumptions, and implied meaning — elements that rigid rule-based systems found difficult to capture. As a result, early language programs frequently produced correct but unnatural responses.

The rise of machine learning transformed this landscape. Instead of being programmed with explicit knowledge, modern systems learn statistical patterns from enormous collections of text. By analyzing how words and sentences appear together, they learn to predict what language is likely to come next. This method allows them to handle variation, adapt to different writing styles, and generate responses that sound natural. Importantly, however, the system is not explicitly taught definitions or intentions; it learns correlations rather than concepts in the traditional sense.

Critics argue that this limitation is fundamental. From their perspective, language is not just about patterns but about meaning grounded in real-world experience. Humans connect words to perception, emotion, and physical interaction. A person understands the word "fire" not only because of linguistic context but because of sensory experience and knowledge of danger. A purely text-based system, critics say, manipulates symbols without genuine understanding — producing language that is convincing but ultimately empty.

Supporters respond that human understanding may also emerge from patterns, albeit richer ones. Children learn language primarily through exposure and interaction rather than formal definitions. Much of everyday communication relies on prediction: listeners anticipate what others will say based on context and prior knowledge. If an AI system consistently responds appropriately across diverse situations, some researchers argue that insisting on a separate, invisible quality called "true understanding" may be unnecessary or impossible to verify.

Another challenge lies in how humans judge understanding in the first place. People often assume others understand language based on behavior rather than direct access to internal mental states. In conversation, we infer comprehension when responses are coherent and contextually appropriate. By this standard, advanced AI systems sometimes appear indistinguishable from human speakers. Yet even humans occasionally use words without fully grasping them, relying on social cues or partial knowledge. This raises the possibility that understanding is not a single state but a continuum ranging from shallow familiarity to deep conceptual mastery.

The debate becomes more complicated when language models produce errors that seem surprisingly human-like. They may generate confident but incorrect explanations or fail when reasoning requires information beyond patterns seen in training data. Such failures suggest limitations in reasoning or grounding. At the same time, humans also exhibit similar limitations: people misremember facts, rely on heuristics, and sometimes produce fluent but inaccurate explanations. The comparison blurs the boundary between human imperfection and machine limitation.

Some researchers propose that the real issue is embodiment — the idea that meaning arises from interacting with the physical world. According to this view, language detached from perception lacks a crucial foundation. Others counter that humans increasingly understand many concepts through language alone. A person may meaningfully discuss black holes, quantum physics, or ancient history without direct experience, relying entirely on symbolic knowledge transmitted by others. If humans can build understanding through language-mediated learning, perhaps machines might also develop meaningful competence without physical embodiment.

Beyond philosophy, the question has practical consequences. AI systems are already used for education, customer support, programming assistance, and scientific research. Whether or not they truly understand language, people interact with them as if they do. This creates risks: users may overestimate reliability, assume

intentionality, or attribute authority where none exists. At the same time, dismissing AI as mere imitation may underestimate its utility as a collaborative tool capable of extending human productivity.

The future may depend less on resolving the philosophical debate and more on clarifying what kinds of understanding are required for different tasks. A system capable of generating useful explanations may not need human-like consciousness, but it must still be transparent, reliable, and designed with awareness of its limits. As language technologies continue to evolve, society may be forced to reconsider not only what machines understand, but what humans have always meant by understanding itself.

1. The main purpose of the passage is to:

- A) prove that machines already possess human-like understanding
- ☒ B) explore competing views about whether AI language use constitutes understanding
- C) explain how to build better language models
- D) argue that AI language systems are fundamentally dangerous

2. The discussion of early rule-based systems mainly serves to show that:

- A) symbolic approaches were more accurate than modern AI
- B) language understanding requires massive data alone
- ☒ C) rigid rules struggled with context and ambiguity
- D) early AI systems were philosophically superior

3. The phrase "understanding is not a single state but a continuum" most directly challenges which assumption?

- ☒ A) That understanding is either fully present or completely absent
- B) That machines can imitate humans
- C) That language learning depends on exposure
- D) That communication requires prediction

4. Which statement best captures the author's implied view of the "true understanding" debate?

- ☒ A) It may be less practically important than many assume
- B) It is already scientifically resolved
- C) It should determine whether AI is used at all
- D) It can be solved through better programming alone

5. Critics mentioned in the passage argue that AI lacks understanding mainly because it:

- ~~A) cannot produce fluent sentences~~
- ~~B) learns too slowly compared to humans~~
- ☒ C) lacks real-world grounding and experience
- ~~D) relies too heavily on grammar rules~~

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6. The embodiment debate is included primarily to illustrate that:
- A) physical interaction is universally accepted as necessary for meaning
 - ☒ B) experts disagree about the foundations of linguistic meaning
 - C) AI systems currently possess embodied knowledge
 - D) language without perception is impossible
7. The author's discussion of humans learning about abstract topics like black holes mainly functions to:
- A) reject embodiment theory entirely
 - B) show that humans rarely rely on direct experience
 - ☒ C) weaken the claim that physical experience is always required for understanding
 - D) prove humans and AI learn identically
8. The author's overall argument structure can best be described as:
- A) presenting one clear position and rejecting alternatives
 - ☒ B) moving from historical background to balanced evaluation and practical reflection
 - C) proving a technical claim through experimental data
 - D) contrasting human intelligence with machine intelligence to show superiority
9. The author's repeated comparison between humans and AI primarily serves which deeper rhetorical purpose?
- A) To argue that humans are less rational than machines
 - B) To demonstrate that philosophical questions are irrelevant to engineering
 - C) To prove that AI systems will inevitably surpass humans
 - ☒ D) To blur rigid conceptual boundaries and encourage reevaluation of fixed categories
10. The passage's final sentence implies that future discussions about AI language should:
- ☒ A) reconsider human assumptions about understanding itself
 - B) focus only on machine architecture
 - C) abandon philosophical inquiry in favor of engineering
 - D) treat AI and humans as fundamentally identical

[CLO 2: Construct well-organized and coherent paragraphs, essays, short stories, and summaries that effectively convey ideas with clarity and purpose.]

Q2(A): Read the following supporting details. Write the **purpose statement** and the **topic sentence** for each paragraph in the space provided below. [3*2= 6 marks]

1. Regular physical exercise is widely recognized for its benefits to mental health. Activities such as jogging, swimming, or yoga release endorphins, which improve mood and reduce stress. Exercise also promotes better sleep, enhances self-esteem, and can decrease symptoms of anxiety and depression. Group exercises

additionally provide social interaction, further improving psychological well-being. Therefore, maintaining an active lifestyle is crucial for both physical and mental health.

Purpose Statement:

Physical exercise has a lot of ^{0.5}
~~different~~ benefits.

Topic Sentence:

Regular physical exercise can benefit ¹
people in many areas of life.

2. Social media platforms have transformed the way people communicate in everyday life. They allow instant sharing of information, maintain long-distance relationships, and provide opportunities for networking. However, excessive use may reduce face-to-face interaction skills and encourage superficial connections. It can also contribute to misinformation and cyberbullying. Understanding these dynamics helps students use social media responsibly and maintain meaningful communication.

Purpose Statement:

3. Communicating with ^X social is both
beneficial and harmful.

Topic Sentence:

It is important for students to understand ¹
the benefits and dangers of social media.

3. Players must learn to manage limited resources such as ammunition, health packs, and currency throughout the game. The game requires quick decision-making under pressure, especially during combat sequences where split-second choices determine survival. Strategic thinking is essential for planning routes, choosing which enemies to engage, and deciding when to avoid confrontation altogether. Additionally, players need strong hand-eye coordination to execute precise movements, aim accurately, and react swiftly to unexpected threats. Memory and pattern recognition also play crucial roles, as players must remember enemy locations, puzzle solutions, and environmental layouts.

Purpose Statement:

Different skills are required ^{0.5}
for players
to play the game.

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Topic Sentence:

0.5

Players must master a variety of skills
to play the game.

Q2(B): Ideas in a paragraph should be logically structured so the reader is able to follow the writer's thought pattern. For each of the following groups of four or five numbered sentences, choose the sentence order that would result in an effective paragraph. There is only ONE correct answer. Transfer the answers (A, B, C, or D) to the table provided on page 13.

[4*2= 8 Marks]

Passage 1

(1) The precision of their construction continues to puzzle engineers and archaeologists today. (2) These massive limestone blocks, some weighing over two tons, were transported from quarries miles away. (3) The Great Pyramid of Giza stands as one of humanity's most remarkable architectural achievements. (4) Workers used copper tools, wooden sledges, and an intricate system of ramps to move and position each stone. (5) Despite decades of research, scholars still debate exactly how ancient Egyptians accomplished this monumental task. (6) The pyramid's base covers thirteen acres and was originally 481 feet tall, making it the world's tallest structure for over 3,800 years. (7) Modern attempts to replicate even small portions of the construction using ancient methods have proven extraordinarily difficult.

A	3, 6, 2, 4, 1, 5, 7	C	2, 3, 6, 4, 5, 1, 7
B	3, 6, 2, 4, 1, 5, 7	D	3, 6, 1, 2, 4, 7, 5

Passage 2

(1) Scientists discovered that these fungi form vast underground networks connecting different plants across entire forests. (2) Recent research has revealed that trees communicate and share resources through an underground fungal network called the "wood wide web." (3) Through these connections, mother trees can nurture their offspring by channeling nutrients to saplings struggling in shaded areas. (4) The network operates through mycorrhizal fungi that attach to tree roots in a mutually beneficial relationship. (5) Even more surprisingly, trees can send chemical alarm signals through the network to warn neighbors about insect attacks or disease. (6) This cooperative behavior challenges the traditional view of forests as collections of individual trees competing for resources. (7) Understanding these fungal networks has profound implications for forest conservation and reforestation strategies.

A	2, 1, 4, 3, 6, 5, 7	C	2, 4, 3, 1, 5, 6, 7
B	4, 2, 1, 3, 5, 7, 6	D	2, 4, 1, 3, 5, 6, 7

Passage 3

(1) During this phase, the brain paralyzes most voluntary muscles to prevent sleepers from physically acting out their dreams. (2) The most vivid and memorable dreams occur during rapid eye movement (REM) sleep, a unique stage characterized by intense brain activity. (3) Interestingly, people awakened during REM sleep report dreams approximately 80-90% of the time, compared to only 50% during other sleep stages. (4) This protective mechanism occasionally fails, leading to a rare condition called REM sleep behavior disorder, where individuals punch, kick, or even sleepwalk while dreaming. (5) Scientists believe REM sleep plays a crucial role in memory consolidation, emotional regulation, and creative problem-solving. (6) The eyes move rapidly beneath closed eyelids, the heart rate increases, and breathing becomes irregular—patterns resembling wakefulness more than sleep. (7) Some researchers propose that dreams during REM sleep allow the brain to process emotional experiences and integrate new information with existing memories. (8) Understanding REM sleep's functions has led to new treatments for nightmares, PTSD, and various sleep disorders.

A	2, 1, 6, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8	C	2, 6, 3, 1, 4, 7, 5, 8
<u>B</u>	2, 6, 1, 4, 3, 5, 7, 8	D	3, 2, 6, 1, 5, 7, 4, 8

Passage 4

(1) Modern memory champions use this ancient technique to memorize thousands of random digits, entire decks of cards, or lengthy poems within minutes. (2) They mentally walk through familiar spaces—childhood homes, regular commute routes, or favorite buildings—placing each item they need to remember at specific locations. (3) The method of loci, also known as the memory palace technique, dates back to ancient Greece and Rome, where orators used it to deliver hours-long speeches without notes. (4) For instance, to remember a grocery list, someone might visualize a giant milk carton blocking their front door, eggs splattered on the hallway floor, and bread loaves stacked on the living room couch. (5) Neuroscience research reveals why this technique works so effectively: the brain's spatial memory systems are far more robust than its systems for remembering abstract information like numbers or words. (6) The technique works by converting abstract information into vivid, bizarre mental images and associating them with physical locations in an imagined space. (7) By linking new information to well-established spatial memories, practitioners can dramatically improve recall accuracy and retention duration.

<u>A</u>	3, 6, 2, 4, 5, 7, 1	C	3, 1, 6, 2, 4, 5, 7
B	3, 6, 4, 2, 5, 7, 1	D	1, 3, 6, 2, 5, 4, 7

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[CLO 3: Apply appropriate grammar rules and writing conventions to produce clear and coherent written content.]

Q3(A): Do as directed. Transfer the answers (A, B, C, or D) to the table provided on page 13.

[5 marks]

1. Choose the sentence with correct parallel structure:

- ☐ A) The committee will review the proposal, discuss the budget, and deciding on a timeline.
- ☐ B) The committee will review the proposal, discussing the budget, and decide on a timeline.
- ☐ C) The committee will review, discuss, and deciding on a timeline.
- ☒ D) The committee will review the proposal, discuss the budget, and decide on a timeline.

2. Identify the error in parallelism: "To succeed in college, students need to attend classes regularly, studying hard, and to participate in extracurricular activities."

- ☐ A) attend classes regularly
- ☒ B) studying hard
- ☐ C) to participate in extracurricular activities
- ☐ D) No error

3. Select the sentence that demonstrates **incorrect parallelism**:

- ☐ A) The job requires attention to detail, efficiency, and meeting deadlines.
- ☐ B) The job requires attention to detail, efficiency, and the ability to meet deadlines.
- ☐ C) The job requires attention to detail, efficiency, and punctuality.
- ☒ D) All sentences are correct.

4. Select the sentence with **properly parallel comparison**:

- ☐ A) Running is more exhausting than to swim or biking.
- ☒ B) Running is more exhausting than swimming or biking.
- ☐ C) Running is more exhausting than to swim or to bike.
- ☐ D) Running is more exhausting than swim or bike.

5. Choose the sentence that **demonstrates correct parallelism**:

- ☐ A) The manager emphasized the importance of listening carefully, to speak clearly, and maintaining eye contact.
- ☐ B) The manager emphasized the importance of listening carefully, to speak clearly, and to maintain eye contact.
- ☐ C) The manager emphasized the importance of listening, speaking clearly, and to maintain eye contact.
- ☒ D) The manager emphasized the importance of listening carefully, speaking clearly, and maintaining eye contact.

Q3(B): Transitions not only help achieve cohesion but also indicate a logical relationship between statements. For the given passage, choose the transition that best connects the ideas discussed. There is only ONE correct answer. Transfer the answers (A, B, C, or D) to the table provided on page 13. [10 Marks]

The discovery of penicillin in 1928 marked a turning point in medical history. [1] _____ Alexander Fleming's accidental observation of mold killing bacteria seemed insignificant at first, it would eventually save millions of lives.

Fleming published his findings in 1929, [2] _____ the scientific community showed little interest in his discovery. The extraction and purification of penicillin proved extremely difficult, [3] _____ Fleming lacked the resources and expertise to develop it as a practical medicine. [4] _____ he continued his other research, hoping someone would recognize penicillin's potential.

A decade later, Howard Florey and Ernst Boris Chain read Fleming's paper, [5] _____ they immediately understood its significance. The team worked tirelessly to purify penicillin, [6] _____ by 1941, they had produced enough to conduct human trials. The results were remarkable, [7] _____ mass production remained a challenge. [8] _____ the outbreak of World War II created urgent demand for antibiotics, British pharmaceutical companies couldn't scale up production quickly enough.

The researchers turned to American pharmaceutical companies for help, [9] _____ the United States had greater industrial capacity. [10] _____ penicillin became widely available by 1945, transforming the treatment of bacterial infections forever.

1.

A	Though	C	Therefore,
B	Since	D	Furthermore,

2.

A	yet	C	so
B	therefore	D	moreover

3.

A	and	C	yet
B	so	D	meanwhile

4.

A	Nevertheless,	C	Meanwhile,
B	Consequently,	D	Similarly,

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5.

☒ A	and	C	yet
☐ B	or	D	for

6.

☐ A	; however ,	C	; moreover ,a
☒ B	and	D	but

7.

☒ A	yet	C	So
☐ B	thus	D	moreover

8.

☐ A	Because	C	Even though
☒ B	While	D	Since

9.

☐ A	since	C	while
☒ B	as	D	though

10.

☐ A	Nevertheless,	☒ C	Ultimately,
☐ B	Therefore,	D	Similarly,

Q3(C): The following questions test your knowledge of paragraph and sentence construction. The given passages are rough draft of an essay/paragraph. The rough draft contains several errors. Read the rough draft and then answer the questions that follow. Some questions will focus on specific sentences and ask if there are any problems with that sentence word choice, word usage, or overall structure. Other questions will refer to the paragraph organization and development. **Transfer the answers (A, B, C, or D) to the table provided on page 13.**

[6 Marks]

Passage 1

(1) The city council of Maplewood has recently approved a groundbreaking initiative called the Urban Rooftop Garden Project, which aims to transform unused rooftop spaces across the city into productive community gardens. (2) The project was launched in response to growing concerns about food insecurity and the lack of green spaces in densely populated urban neighborhoods. (3) Funding for the initiative was secured through a combination of federal environmental grants and private sponsorships from local businesses committed to sustainable development. (4) A steering committee comprising urban planners, nutritionists, community activists, and representatives from local schools will oversee the project's implementation and expansion. (5) Research consistently demonstrates that access to green spaces significantly improves mental health outcomes in urban populations. (6) Furthermore, community gardens have been shown to foster stronger neighborhood bonds and reduce feelings of social isolation among residents. (7) Because participants in the program reported feeling more connected to their neighbors and more invested in their community's

wellbeing. (8) The gardens also provide an invaluable educational opportunity for children and young adults to learn about sustainability, nutrition, and environmental responsibility in addition. (9) By the end of its first year, the project aims to have established gardens on at least 30 rooftops, providing fresh produce to over 500 families across Maplewood's most underserved neighborhoods.

Question 1. Which sentence in the third paragraph is a nonstandard sentence?

- A) Sentence 5
- B) Sentence 6
- ☒ C) Sentence 7
- D) Sentence 8

Question 2. Which of the following changes should be made to Sentence 8 of the passage?

- A) Change "invaluable" to "valuable"
- B) Change "sustainability" to "sustainable"
- ☒ C) Remove the word "in addition"
- D) Change "children and young adults" to "children and young adult's"

Question 3. Which of the following sentences, if inserted after Sentence 2 of the passage, would best develop the ideas in the first paragraph?

- A) The Urban Rooftop Garden Project has attracted media attention from several national news outlets interested in sustainable urban development.
- ☒ B) During its pilot phase, the project successfully converted five rooftops into thriving gardens, yielding over 2,000 pounds of fresh vegetables that were distributed directly to local food banks and low-income families.
- C) Several other cities across the country are also struggling with food insecurity and might benefit from similar initiatives in the future.
- D) Urban gardening has become an increasingly popular trend among young professionals who are passionate about environmental sustainability.

Passage 2

The Lost Art of Letter Writing

(1) In an age dominated by instant messaging and social media, the tradition of handwritten letter writing has quietly faded into near obscurity, taking with it a deeply personal form of human connection. (2) Unlike digital communication, a handwritten letter carries the writer's personality in every stroke of the pen, every crossed out word, and every deliberate choice of stationery. (3) Letters written by historical figures like Abraham Lincoln and Virginia Woolf are now treasured artifacts that reveal intimate details about their thoughts feelings and daily lives that no email could ever replicate.

(4) The psychological benefits of letter writing extend far beyond simple communication. (5) Psychologists who study written expression have found that composing a thoughtful letter forces the writer to organize their thoughts more deliberately than typing a quick message. (6) This deliberate process of slowing down and choosing words carefully has been linked to reduced anxiety, greater emotional clarity, and improved empathy toward the recipient. (7) Many therapists now recommends letter writing as a therapeutic exercise for patients struggling with grief, unresolved conflict, or difficulty expressing emotions verbally. (8) The act of physically sealing an envelope and sending it carries a sense of intention and commitment that clicking "send" simply cannot replicate.

(9) _____. (10) Local community centers, libraries, and schools across the country have begun hosting letter-writing workshops that teach participants everything from proper salutation formats to the art of selecting the right words for different recipients. (11) Participants in these workshops

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often report feeling surprised by how rewarding the experience is, describing a sense of calm and satisfaction that is rarely associated with digital communication.

Question 4. Which of the following revisions is necessary in Sentence 7 of the passage?

- ☐ A) Many therapists now recommends letter writing as a therapeutic exercise for patients struggling with grief, unresolved conflict, or difficulty to express emotions verbally.
- ☒ B) Many therapists now recommend letter writing as a therapeutic exercise for patients struggling with grief, unresolved conflict, or difficulty expressing emotions verbally.
- ☐ C) Many therapists now recommends letter writing as a therapeutic exercise for patients who struggle with grief, unresolved conflict, or difficulty expressing emotions verbally.
- ☒ D) Many therapists now recommend letter writing as a therapeutic exercise for patients struggling with grief, unresolved conflict, or difficulty to express emotions verbally.

Question 5. Which of the following sentences, if inserted in the blank numbered Sentence 9, would be most consistent with the development and grammar of the paragraph?

- ☒ A) Fortunately, a quiet resurgence of interest in handwritten letters is emerging, with growing communities of enthusiasts dedicated to reviving this thoughtful practice.
- ☐ B) People everywhere are beginning to appreciate the lost traditions of the past, including calligraphy, pottery, and bookbinding.
- ☐ C) Although letter writing has declined, other traditional art forms have also suffered a similar fate in the modern digital age.
- ☐ D) Revive your letter writing habits and reconnect with friends and family through the lost art of handwritten correspondence.

Question 6. Which of the following changes is needed in the passage?

- ☐ A) Sentence 6: Insert a comma after "down"
- ☐ B) Sentence 1: Replace "near" with "nearly"
- ☒ C) Sentence 3: Insert a comma after "thoughts"
- ☐ D) Sentence 8: Replace "cannot" with "can not"